Give AI some CRediT

Collaborator Agreement for use of Generative AI in Scientific Research Outputs

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Abstract

This document is a template for scientific collaborators to use at the beginning of a project to facilitate transparent and congruent generative AI use in the project.

Purpose

The Contributor Role Taxonomy (CRediT) is the scaffolding to guide collaborator discussion and agreement about the use of GenAI tools in the shared research outputs.

Guide to Use and Discussions

Agreement Checklists

Role	Role Definition	Example Tasks
Conceptualization	Ideas; formulation or evolution of overarching research goals and aims.	Identifying issues, questions or problems that warrant research.
		Developing research questions and hypotheses.
		Developing research frameworks, tools or experimental paradigms.
		Refining and adapting overarching research goals and aims.
		Conducting tasks like data processing, cleaning, cataloging, annotating, archiving, modeling, and retention.
		Integrating and aggregating data in diverse formats and from diverse sources.
		Managing and updating data descriptions and metadata, including maintaining version control and associated documentation.

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Role	Role Definition	Example Tasks
Data Curation	Management activities to annotate (produce metadata), scrub data and maintain research data (including software/code, where it is necessary for interpreting the data itself) for initial use and later re-use.	Developing or implementing data preservation strategies to ensure data remains findable, accessible, interoperable and reusable.
Formal Analysis	Application of statistical, mathematical, computational, or other formal techniques to analyse or synthesize study data.	Uncovering patterns and identifying relationships between variables and quantitative or qualitative datasets.
		Performing statistical tests to compare different groups within a study or evaluate change.
		Applying AI and machine learning models to predict outcomes.
		Developing computational simulations to model complex systems or phenomena.
Funding Acquisition	Acquisition of the financial support for the project leading to this publication.	Identifying suitable funding sources, assessing eligibility and communicating requirements with team members.
		Developing grant proposals and coordinating the submission process.
		Developing budgets and allocating funds to match project scope and funder expectations.
Investigation	Conducting a research and investigation process, specifically performing the experiments, or data/evidence collection.	Following or modifying methods to collect or generate data through quantitative and/or qualitative research approaches.
		Testing research hypotheses and documenting the research process.
		Searching and reviewing the literature, samples, data and other evidence.
		Reporting findings for further discussion, analysis, and exchange of ideas.
Methodology	Development or design of methodology; creation of models.	Developing quantitative and/or qualitative methodologies and frameworks.
		Defining search strategies and determining criteria for systematic literature reviews.
		Determining study design such as participant selection, materials, settings, data characteristics, data collection, measurement, and analysis techniques.
		Monitoring and reporting progress, timelines, budgets, and compliance with ethical, governance, legal, health, safety, and other relevant standards.

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Role	Role Definition	Example Tasks
Project Administration	Management and coordination responsibility for the research activity planning and execution.	Recruiting participants needed for the research method (e.g. interviews, focus groups, surveys, fieldwork, clinical trials).
		Organizing logistics for expeditions, fieldwork, equipment setup, and space allocation that support research operations.
		Managing correspondence with team members, journal editors, and various institutional departments.
Resources	Provision of study materials, reagents, materials, patients, laboratory samples, animals, instrumentation, computing resources, or other analysis tools.	Preparing, transporting or managing access to samples, artefacts, tools, equipment, documents, archives, and digital/physical infrastructure.
		Inventory management, safekeeping of samples and providing reports on availability and state of resources.
		Calibrating and maintaining instruments and equipment.
		Coordinating data storage solutions and computational resources.
Software	Programming, software development; designing computer programs; implementation of the computer code and supporting algorithms; testing of existing code components.	Designing, developing, testing, debugging, implementing, documenting, sharing and maintaining code.
		Developing, maintaining, managing and optimizing digital infrastructure, libraries, and databases.
		Conducting data extraction, data mining, and parsing content for qualitative or quantitative data collection and analysis.
		Ensuring interoperability, functionality, and scalability of code, databases, systems or platforms across different environments.
Supervision	Oversight and leadership responsibility for the research activity planning and execution, including mentorship external to the core team.	Overseeing researchers and other team members by setting milestones, tracking progress, ensuring quality of deliverables, and promoting adherence to ethics and integrity norms.
		Teaching, training, moderating and providing personal or professional advice to team members.
		Guiding teams in refining methods, interpreting results, and addressing interpersonal challenges.
		Collecting, logging, and reporting individual contributions to research.

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Role	Role Definition	Example Tasks
Validation	Verification, whether as a part of the activity or separate, of the overall replication/reproducibility of results/experiments and other research outputs.	Ensuring the integrity, rigor and reliability of data, methods, results and resources through reviewing, verification, benchmarking, factchecking and replicating.
		Conducting pilot tests or preliminary studies to validate data collection instruments and protocols.
		Appraising studies included in systematic reviews and ensuring compliance with established review standards or reporting frameworks.
		Testing computational models or simulations against known outcomes for accuracy.
Visualization	Preparation, creation and/or presentation of the published work, specifically visualization/data presentation.	Using data to create charts, graphs or figures.
		Creating videos and other interactive media for communicating the findings.
Writing - original draft	Preparation, creation and/or presentation of the published work, specifically writing the initial draft (including substantive translation).	Creating the first and full version of an article.
		Drafting substantial original text within a section or across sections in an article.
Writing - review & editing	Preparation, creation and/or presentation of the published work by those from the original research group, specifically critical review, commentary or revision - including pre- or post-publication stages.	Reviewing, copy-editing, refining language and providing comments and suggestions.
		Revising content based on feedback from internal and external reviewers.
		Providing review input of figures, tables, and supplementary materials.

Document Each GenAI Contribution

This will serve as running documentation of GenAI work sessions and how it was used to contribute to the scientific research outputs.

AI Contribution	**CRediT Role**	**Model & Version**	**Access Interface**	**Access Platform**	**Agents, Skills and Prompts**	**User**	**Date**
Code refactoring and documentation	Software	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Positron Assistant	Positron	None	Althea Marks	2026-05-21

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Convert markdown to csv	Software	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Posit Assistant	Positron	None	Althea Marks	2026-07-01